PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

Pigment & Color Theory

Healed color = pigment + skin showing through. Plan for both.

Fitzpatrick skin type

I	II	III	IV	V	VI
Very fair	Fair	Medium	Olive	Brown	Deep brown
Light, soft browns; skip heavy ash.	Light to medium, soft neutral.	Medium browns to match undertone.	Deeper, warmer browns.	Deep warm browns.	Deepest warm pigments.

Types IV–VI: higher risk of dark marks and raised scars. Use machine shading, a lighter hand, patch test.

Undertone guide

Cool
Blue or purple veins, silver suits

Neutral or ash pigment.

Warm
Green veins, gold suits

Neutral or warm pigment.

Not sure
Mixed signs, or both metals suit

Neutral-warm. Brows heal cooler.

Opposites neutralize

Healed-color troubleshooting

HEALS AS	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Grey or blue	Carbon/black-based pigment, or too deep (Tyndall effect).	Orange or warm corrector, then a warm brown.
Red, pink or salmon	Yellow in the brown faded first, leaving the red.	Green or olive corrector, or a more neutral brown.
Greenish	Yellow-based pigment over old blue-grey work.	Red or warm corrector, then a neutral-warm brown.
Too dark or solid	Over-saturated, or shade too deep for the skin.	Let it fade, or saline lighten. Lighter shade and hand next time.

CORRECTION RULES

- Neutralize with the opposite on the color wheel.
- Space correction sessions at least 8 weeks apart.
- Get prior brand and photos; log every lot.
- Heavy old work: lighten or saline first.

LIP NEUTRALIZATION

- Dark or cool lips: coral or peach corrector first.
- Final lip shade at the next session, 8 weeks on.
- Plan 2–3 sessions; lips heal cooler and lighter.
- Cold sore history: client asks their physician first.

Avoid heavy titanium dioxide lighteners. They heal unpredictably, can leave a chalky or grey cast, and can darken under laser. Follow each pigment maker's instructions.